

Ragged to DEATH

Amann Kachroo's death sparks a nationwide campaign to stamp out the age-old practice

By Mihir Srivastava

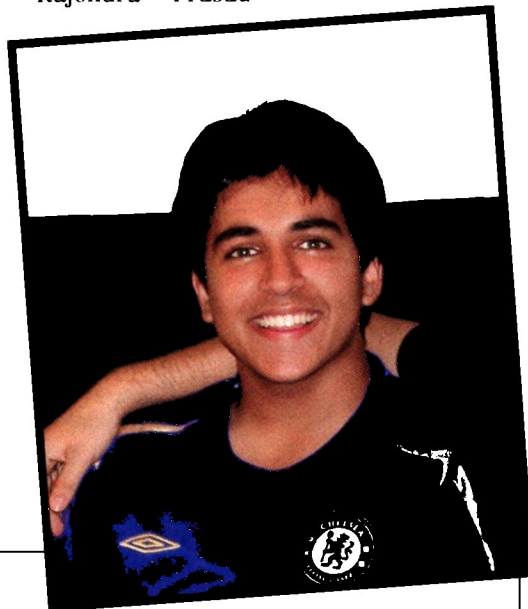
Jessica Lall, Priyadarshini Mattoo, Nitish Katara—three tragic victims murdered in their prime went on to become powerful symbols of what public crusades for justice led by family members against money, power and influence can do. Now, add one more name to that list: Amann Kachroo, the 19-year-old medical student who died after being brutally beaten by drunken seniors at a medical

college in Kangra, Himachal Pradesh. The case has not just shocked the nation but given birth to a growing countrywide campaign against ragging in colleges. Hundreds of people gathered in Delhi to launch the campaign, named after Amann, to ban ragging in educational institutions, spearheaded by his grieving but feisty father, Rajendra Kachroo. Though condemned by the Supreme Court, ragging continues because of tradition and the twisted sense of

power it gives senior students over their juniors.

The protest marches in Delhi and other places have forced the Centre and Himachal Pradesh Government to announce steps to formulate anti-ragging laws. However, for one family, it is a case of too little too late. It was, in many ways, the chronicle of a death foretold. "What would be your contribution to the world if you die today?" he had asked a friend in Dr Rajendra Prasad

AMANN HAS BECOME THE RALLYING POINT FOR THE ANTI-RAGGING MOVEMENT



AMANN'S HANDWRITTEN ANALYSIS OF RAGGING

